

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 6

APUSH-SAQ6-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Period 7: 1890–1945

Theme: ARC — American and Regional Culture

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation.

A historian of Prohibition argues that the Eighteenth Amendment represented the high point of a long reform tradition that linked moral discipline, Protestant activism, women’s organizing, and faith in government action. According to this interpretation, Prohibition showed that many Americans believed law could improve private behavior and strengthen the nation.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation.

A historian of the 1920s argues that Prohibition exposed the limits of moral regulation in a modern urban society. According to this interpretation, illegal drinking, organized crime, uneven enforcement, and resentment toward rural Protestant reformers turned Prohibition into a symbol of cultural conflict.

- (a) Describe one major difference between the two interpretations of Prohibition.
- (b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.
- (c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as Source A emphasizing Prohibition as a reform achievement rooted in moral activism, while Source B emphasizes Prohibition as evidence of cultural conflict, lawbreaking, and limits of government regulation.
- (b) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source A, such as the temperance movement, Woman’s Christian Temperance Union, Anti-Saloon League, Progressive reform, Protestant moral activism, women’s suffrage activism, or the passage of the Eighteenth Amendment and Volstead Act.
- (c) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source B, such as speakeasies, bootlegging, organized crime, uneven enforcement, urban resistance, immigrant and Catholic opposition to prohibitionist culture, or repeal through the Twenty-First Amendment.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should treat Prohibition as both a reform movement and a source of cultural conflict. It should explain why some Americans viewed prohibition as moral progress while others viewed it as coercive, unrealistic, or unevenly enforced.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ6-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Period 3: 1754–1800

Period: Period 3: 1754–1800

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A Republican newspaper printer writing privately to a political ally, Philadelphia, 1798.

“The party in power says that criticism weakens the nation while France threatens our ships. But if every sharp word against an officer is called sedition, then elections become ceremonies rather than safeguards. I do not defend foreign agents, but I fear a government that treats opposition newspapers as enemies more than I fear any pamphlet printed in haste.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the argument made in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the situation described in the source reflected broader debates about federal power in the 1790s.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as the Alien and Sedition Acts, the Quasi-War with France, Federalist-Republican conflict, partisan newspapers, fears of foreign influence, or the growth of the First Party System.
- (b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s point of view as a Republican printer or opposition newspaperman shaped the argument by emphasizing press freedom, fear of Federalist repression, electoral accountability, and suspicion of expanded federal authority.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader debate, such as conflict over civil liberties, national security, states’ rights, federal authority, party opposition, the Virginia and Kentucky Resolutions, or the meaning of republican government.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should connect the source to the partisan conflicts of the 1790s. It should explain how fears of foreign threats and domestic dissent contributed to debates over civil liberties, federal power, and the legitimacy of political opposition.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ6-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Period 4: 1800–1848

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described data table created for this practice exam.

The table is titled “Cotton Production and Forced Migration in the United States, 1800–1860.”

Indicator | 1800 | 1830 | 1860

Cotton production | relatively limited | rapidly expanding | dominant export crop

Enslaved population in the Deep South | smaller than Upper South | growing quickly | very large

Domestic slave trade from Upper South to Deep South | limited | expanding | extensive

Land under cotton cultivation | concentrated in older areas | moving into Alabama, Mississippi, and Louisiana | expanded across the Cotton Kingdom

Dependence on international textile demand | growing | high | very high

The table notes that figures are approximate and are intended to show broad historical trends rather than exact totals.

- (a) Describe one economic change reflected in the table.
- (b) Explain one cause of the economic change described in part (a).
- (c) Explain one social or political consequence of the changes reflected in the table.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Describes a valid change, such as rapid expansion of cotton production, growth of the Cotton Kingdom, increased domestic slave trade, expansion of slavery into the Deep South, or increasing dependence on cotton exports.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant cause, such as the cotton gin, demand from British and northern textile mills, removal of Native peoples from southeastern lands, fertile lands in the Deep South, expansionist policy, or global demand for cotton textiles.

(c) 1 point: Explains a relevant consequence, such as the forced migration of enslaved people, strengthening of plantation slavery, increased sectional tension, expansion of proslavery politics, family separation among enslaved people, or deepening southern dependence on export agriculture.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect cotton expansion to technology, land, labor, and global markets. It should avoid treating cotton growth as only an agricultural development and should explain how it intensified slavery, forced migration, and sectional conflict.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ6-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 5 — Period 5: 1844–1877

Period: Period 5: 1844–1877

Theme: SOC — Social Structures

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which the Civil War transformed life on the home front in the United States from 1861 to 1865.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Original simulated letter from a northern factory worker to his brother in the Union army, Lowell, Massachusetts, 1862; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“The mill runs on army cloth, and the owners say the war has made business necessary to the nation. Wages have risen some, but prices rise faster. Some men enlist for bounty money, while others remain because mothers, wives, and children depend on factory pay. The war is far from the shop floor, yet it reaches every payday.”

Sourcing Cues: The letter reflects the perspective of a wage worker experiencing wartime production, inflation, and labor pressures.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated diary entry from a Confederate woman managing a small farm, Georgia, 1863; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“With my husband away, I bargain for salt, mend harness, and plant what corn I can. The army takes horses and asks for bacon, but the children cannot eat promises. Neighbors speak of patriotism, yet many women ask how a country can be defended if its households are left without bread.”

Sourcing Cues: The diary reflects the burdens of war on Confederate women, rural households, and food supply.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Described map created for this practice exam, United States and Confederacy, 1861–1865.

Source Type: Described map.

The map shows major Union railroad corridors connecting northeastern cities, the Midwest, and military supply centers. It also shows the Union naval blockade along the Atlantic and Gulf coasts, Confederate rail lines with fewer connections, and areas of major food shortages in parts of the Confederacy by 1864.

Sourcing Cues: The map emphasizes how transportation, blockade, and infrastructure shaped home-front experiences differently in the Union and Confederacy.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Original simulated testimony from an enslaved man who reached a Union army camp, coastal South Carolina, 1862; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Testimony-style excerpt.

“When the gunboats came near, people listened for news. Some left at night and brought children with them. The soldiers first called us contraband, but we knew we were not goods. Work in the camp was hard, yet it was work done with the hope that the old master’s claim was broken.”

Sourcing Cues: The testimony reflects the perspective of enslaved people using wartime disruption to seek freedom and reshape the meaning of the conflict.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Wartime price table created for this practice exam, Union and Confederacy, 1861–1865.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Selected Home-Front Economic Pressures During the Civil War.”

Indicator | Union states | Confederate states

Industrial production | expanded in many areas | limited by blockade and shortages

Inflation | significant but manageable for many households | extremely severe by 1864–1865
Food supply | uneven but generally stronger | severe shortages in many regions
Government finance | taxes, bonds, and paper currency | paper currency and shortages of credit
Civilian unrest | draft and labor protests in some cities | food riots and desertion pressures in some areas

Sourcing Cues: The table compares economic stress across the Union and Confederacy and highlights uneven effects of wartime mobilization.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Original simulated broadside from a northern anti-draft meeting, New York City, 1863; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Political broadside excerpt.

“The rich man may purchase a substitute while the laborer is ordered from his family. If this war is for Union, let sacrifice be equal. If it is now also for emancipation, let politicians explain why workingmen must fight while their own sons remain at home.”

Sourcing Cues: The broadside reflects class resentment, racial politics, and opposition to conscription in some northern urban communities.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Original simulated circular from a freedpeople’s aid association, Boston, 1864; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Reform organization circular.

“Teachers, clothing, tools, and books are needed for people escaping slavery into Union lines. The war has opened a door, but freedom requires more than arrival. Schools, paid labor, family protection, and legal recognition must follow military victory.”

Sourcing Cues: The circular reflects northern reformers’ efforts to support formerly enslaved people and connect wartime emancipation to social reconstruction.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which the Civil War transformed home-front life from 1861 to 1865. The thesis must make an argument, such as that the war substantially transformed labor, gender roles, household economies, race relations, and federal or military involvement in civilian life, though effects differed sharply by region, race, and class.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as sectional conflict, secession, slavery, industrial differences between North and South, the Union blockade, mobilization for total war, emancipation, or prewar gender and labor systems.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about wartime industry, household labor, transportation and blockade, enslaved people’s flight to Union lines, inflation, conscription, class conflict, or aid to freedpeople.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as the Homestead Act, Morrill Land-Grant Act, Pacific Railway Act, Legal Tender Act, National Banking Acts, New York City Draft Riots, Emancipation Proclamation, United States Colored Troops, Sanitary Commission, Richmond Bread Riot, or Clara Barton.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the

argument. For example, a student might analyze the northern worker's class perspective, the Confederate woman's household burden, the map's emphasis on infrastructure, the formerly enslaved man's view of freedom, the anti-draft broadside's political purpose, or the aid circular's reform goals.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as explaining that the Civil War transformed the home front unevenly; comparing Union and Confederate experiences; showing how emancipation changed the war's meaning; or explaining that wartime hardship expanded some opportunities while increasing coercion, violence, and inequality for others.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that the Civil War transformed home-front life to a large extent by expanding wartime production, disrupting households, intensifying inflation and food shortages, creating class and draft conflict, and opening paths toward emancipation. It should also compare Union and Confederate experiences and explain how race, class, gender, and region shaped those changes. Useful document groupings include industrial labor, Confederate household hardship, infrastructure and blockade, enslaved people's wartime agency, economic pressure, anti-draft politics, and aid to freedpeople. Relevant outside evidence could include the Emancipation Proclamation, New York City Draft Riots, Richmond Bread Riot, National Banking Acts, Legal Tender Act, U.S. Colored Troops, or the Sanitary Commission.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ6-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Period 8: 1945–1980

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the end of World War II through the early twenty-first century, conservative political movements gained influence in the United States. These movements drew support from many sources, including anti-communism, reactions against liberal reform, religious activism, tax revolts, business interests, debates over federal power, concerns about social change, and regional shifts in political power.

Evaluate the most significant causes of the rise of modern conservatism in the United States from 1945 to 2000.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the most significant causes of the rise of modern conservatism from 1945 to 2000. The thesis must make a causal argument rather than simply list conservative ideas.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to postwar politics, such as the Cold War, New Deal liberalism, the Great Society, civil rights activism, social movements of the 1960s and 1970s, economic instability, religious change, suburban and Sun Belt growth, or distrust of government after Vietnam and Watergate.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as anti-communism, National Review, Barry Goldwater's 1964 campaign, backlash against

Great Society programs, opposition to busing or affirmative action, the New Right, the Religious Right, Roe v. Wade backlash, tax revolts such as Proposition 13, Sun Belt political growth, stagflation, Reagan's election, deregulation, or debates over welfare and federal spending. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about causes of conservative growth.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining causation, such as showing how anti-communism, economic concerns, religious mobilization, racial and cultural backlash, business organizing, regional realignment, or distrust of federal power contributed to conservative political success.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as distinguishing economic, social, religious, and foreign-policy conservatism; explaining that conservatism grew through both grassroots activism and elite organization; recognizing regional differences; or showing how conservative movements responded to liberal reform while also building their own positive vision of markets, family, religion, and limited government.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should explain causes, not just describe conservative beliefs or list conservative politicians. It might argue that modern conservatism rose because anti-communism, backlash against liberal reform, religious activism, tax resistance, economic instability, and Sun Belt growth converged between the 1950s and 1980s. Strong responses should also recognize that conservatism was not a single movement; economic conservatives, religious conservatives, anti-communists, business groups, and grassroots activists often had overlapping but distinct priorities.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ6

· APUSH-SAQ6-001: Unit 7; Period 7: 1890–1945; perspectives include modern secondary historians of Prohibition as moral reform and Prohibition as cultural conflict; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast temperance/Progressive moral regulation with urban resistance, organized crime, uneven enforcement, and rural-urban cultural division; historical development is Prohibition, Eighteenth Amendment, Volstead Act, and repeal politics; reasoning path is comparison; misconception targeted is treating Prohibition only as a failed alcohol law rather than both a reform achievement and a cultural conflict.

· APUSH-SAQ6-002: Unit 3; Period 3: 1754–1800; perspective is Republican newspaper printer during the Alien and Sedition Acts crisis; source type is original simulated primary text; source viewpoint emphasizes press freedom, opposition politics, fear of Federalist repression, and civil liberties during foreign-policy tension with France; historical development is the Alien and Sedition Acts, Quasi-War, First Party System, and debates over federal power in the 1790s; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to civil liberties, national security, and party conflict; misconception targeted is assuming early U.S. politics were nonpartisan or that civil-liberty debates began only in later periods.

· APUSH-SAQ6-003: Unit 4; Period 4: 1800–1848; perspectives include enslaved people, plantation owners, cotton producers, textile manufacturers, traders, and expansionist policymakers; non-text source type is plain-text economic and forced-migration data table; visual/data pattern is cotton production expansion, growth of the Deep South enslaved population, domestic slave trade, land expansion, and international textile demand; historical development is the Cotton Kingdom, cotton gin, domestic slave trade, and expansion of plantation slavery before the Civil War;

reasoning path is causation linking technology, land, global demand, forced migration, and sectional politics; misconception targeted is treating cotton expansion as only agricultural growth rather than a system of coerced labor and forced migration.

· APUSH-DBQ6-001: Unit 5; Period 5: 1844–1877; DBQ topic is Civil War home-front transformation from 1861 to 1865; document types include northern factory worker letter, Confederate woman's diary, described infrastructure/blockade map, testimony-style excerpt from an enslaved man reaching Union lines, wartime price/economic pressure table, northern anti-draft broadside, and freedpeople's aid association circular; document perspectives include wage workers, Confederate rural women, enslaved people seeking freedom, Union military/logistics systems, urban anti-draft workers, reformers, households, and wartime governments; main argument paths include wartime industry, inflation, Confederate shortages, transportation and blockade, gendered household burdens, enslaved people's agency, anti-draft class conflict, and early freedpeople's aid; outside evidence possibilities include Emancipation Proclamation, New York City Draft Riots, Richmond Bread Riot, National Banking Acts, Legal Tender Act, Homestead Act, Morrill Land-Grant Act, Pacific Railway Act, U.S. Colored Troops, Sanitary Commission, and Clara Barton; sourcing opportunities include worker class perspective, Confederate household hardship, map as infrastructure analysis, formerly enslaved testimony, anti-draft political purpose, and reform organization audience; visual/data/map types include described Civil War railroad/blockade/shortage map and Union/Confederate economic pressure data table.

· APUSH-LEQ6-001: Units 8–9; Periods 8–9 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is causes of the rise of modern conservatism from 1945 to 2000; historical reasoning process is causation; evidence categories include Cold War anti-communism, National Review, Goldwater campaign, backlash against Great Society programs, opposition to busing and affirmative action, New Right, Religious Right, Roe v. Wade backlash, Proposition 13, Sun Belt growth, stagflation, Reagan election, deregulation, welfare debates, and distrust of federal government after Vietnam and Watergate; complexity path is distinguishing economic, religious, cultural, anti-communist, business, regional, and grassroots causes of conservative growth; misconception targeted is treating modern conservatism as beginning only with Reagan or as only a presidential/electoral movement.